

General Lit.





About the Course

Journey into the 19th century via novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from and about the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12



Placement & Combining Tips

Some books shared with other high school grades. Literature, history, and geography lessons work in sync in Grades 9-12, so it is best to consider all three together when placing students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
11-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 2 times/week 30 min	Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass Up from Slavery James Jane Eyre The Count of Monte Cristo Short stories and other writings Things Fall Apart The Souls of Black Folk

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

☐ Jane Eyre (Term 2: Option 1) This novel touches on difficult themes, including a child in an unhappy home situation, loss, a romantic relationship with a significant secret, mental illness,

and questions of faith and duty. Teachers may wish to preview these elements before assigning.

☐ James (Term 2: Option 2) This novel is recommended for mature students, as it includes strong language, racial slurs and stereotypes, and graphic scenes of violence and abuse, mainly directed towards the enslaved characters in the novel. These scenes intensify toward the end of the novel. Pre-reading or familiarizing yourself with the content to determine suitability for your student(s) is encouraged. Frankenstein or Silas Marner from General Lit.: Grades 9-10 are also possible alternatives.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit.: Grades 11-12



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



Up from Slavery



James



Jane Eyre



The Count of Monte Cristo

Short stories and other writings



Things Fall Apart



The Souls of Black Folk



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

∞ [Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF](#)

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



General Lit.: Grades 11-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ INTRO

Alexandre Dumas's *The Count of Monte Cristo* is a well-loved story of betrayal, revenge, and redemption. It was originally written as a serial, so as you read, imagine the experience of the first readers who were continuously given cliff hangers and had to wait for the next installment of the plot!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Plan to read for about 20 minutes each week and leave 10 minutes for narration and discussion. The edition chosen for this course is the abridged version, but it is still too long to cover in two terms just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time. Or just read 20 minutes each week, and if you are interested, you can finish the book after the end of the term.

- There are a lot of characters in this novel! Begin a character list today, and jot down a few details. What kind of man is Edmond Dantès at the opening of the novel?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 2

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass is a classic 19th-century autobiography that details the author's story from slavery to freedom. Douglass was born enslaved in Maryland in 1818 and escaped to freedom when he was around twenty years old. He went on to have a remarkable life as a national leader of the abolitionist movement, writer, orator, and statesman.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "I was born in Tuckahoe" - "a good overseer."

- What do we learn about Frederick Douglass's family in this opening reading?
- What initial impressions do you have of his narrative style? How might this be connected to his aims for this autobiography? Consider in particular how he describes the more difficult and violent episodes from his childhood.

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

Today, we begin reading the autobiography of Booker T. Washington. It was first written as a periodical, but was later put into book form. Washington was born a slave, but was still a child when emancipation occurred. He later founded Tuskegee Institute in Alabama and spent his life advancing the cause of equal rights. His writings give a window into the Reconstruction period that followed the American Civil War.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I p.1-11 "I was born" - "owners as to the future."

- How does Washington describe his childhood? How does he describe the day of emancipation?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content: Douglass's *Narrative* contains several graphic descriptions of beatings and racial slurs.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think has happened at the party?
- Describe the character of Mercédès and continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-13 "The home plantation" - "stone-like coolness."

- Reflect on Douglass's descriptions of the slave's songs. What purposes does singing serve? How has it been misunderstood?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.11-22 "After the coming of freedom" - "or a handkerchief."

- Why were names so important to Washington and the other newly freed people?
- How does Washington describe the conditions of formerly enslaved people immediately after emancipation?
- How is education described in this chapter? Why did Washington see it as so important?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think of the character of Villefort? What is his secret?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 6

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)



Term 1

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.13-19 "His savage barbarity" - "voice of tranquil music."

- Why do you think it is important for his narrative that Douglass describes violence in such detail? How does it strengthen his anti-slavery argument?
 - Why was leaving Colonel Lloyd's plantation such a turning point for Douglass?
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→ **RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)**

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.3-4 p.22-34 "Finally, the great day came" - "get through the school year."

- What hardships does he encounter while traveling, and how does he respond to them? Where does he find the strength to persevere?
- Describe Mrs. Ruffner and how she impacted his life. Who else had an impact on Washington?